Lab 08 – Remote Desktop Services

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Contents

What is RDS?

Windows Server role to deliver **desktops/apps** remotely

Session Desktop (full desktop) or
RemoteApp (single app)

Access via **mstsc** or **RD Web Access**

Centralized management + lower client requirements

Scenario

- **Context:** Small educational lab, multiple students
- **Need:** Secure centralized Windows desktop access
- **Solution:** RDS on Windows Server 2022 + Active Directory
- **Benefit:** No local install, simpler updates, lower client requirements

Target result & architecture

AD DS	Identity and access control
DNS	Resolve domain names like **lab8.local**
RDS	Provide remote sessions (Session Desktop / RemoteApp)
Network	Bridged adapter (server reachable on LAN)
Clients	LAB-PC-1, LAB-PC-2 (physical machines)

Implementation

Server VM

- VirtualBox + Windows Server 2022
- Bridged network, 10.0.97.61
- Hostname: RDS-SRV01

Identity

- Domain: lab8.local
- AD users: student1, student2
- Group: RDS_Students

RDS Deployment

- Quick Start → **Session-based desktop**
- Collection: QuickSessionCollection
- Access: only `LAB8\RDS_Students`

Active Directory Setup

Install Roles

- Active Directory Domain Services
- DNS Server
- New Forest: lab8.local
- DNS auto-configured during promotion

Client DNS note

- School DNS did not resolve lab8.local
- We used a **hosts-file entry** on clients for RDS-SRV01.lab8.local

RDS Installation

Step 1: Add RDS roles/features

- Server Manager → Add Roles and Features → Remote Desktop Service

Step 2: Deployment:

- Quick Start method (single server)
- Session-based desktop deployment
- Auto-creates QuickSessionCollection

Installed Components:

- RD Session Host
- RD Connection Broker
- RD Web Access

RDS Setup

Collection access control:

- Collections → `QuickSessionCollection` → User Groups
- Remove: Domain Users
- Add: `LAB8\RDS_Students`

RD Web Access (what + where):

- Web portal to launch Full Desktop / RemoteApp
- URL: https://RDS-SRV01.lab8.local/rdweb
  (or https://10.0.97.61/rdweb)

Result: Only authorized students see and launch resources

RD Web Access

Step 1: Fix name resolution

- School DNS doesn't resolve `lab8.local`
- Add hosts entry on each client:
  - `C:\Windows\System32\drivers\etc\hosts`
  - `10.0.97.61 RDS-SRV01.lab8.local`

Step 2: Fix HTTPS warning (certificate)

- RDS → Edit Deployment Properties → Certificates → RD Web Access
- Create self-signed cert: `RDS-SRV01.lab8.local`
- Trust it on clients

Access:

- https://RDS-SRV01.lab8.local/rdweb | https://10.0.97.61/rdweb

Testing

- **Method 1: Direct RDP (full desktop)**
- Open Remote Desktop Connection (mstsc)
- Server: RDS-SRV01.lab8.local or 10.0.97.61
- Login: LAB8\student1 or student2

- **Method 2: RD Web Access / RemoteApp**
- Browser → https://RDS-SRV01.lab8.local/rdweb
- Login with domain credentials
- Launch full desktop or RemoteApp (.rdp)

Wrap-Up

Delivered:

- RDS Session Desktop + RD Web Access (RemoteApp)
- AD DS domain: `lab8.local` (RDS-SRV01 / `10.0.97.61`)
- Access limited to `LAB8\RDS_Students`

Verified in demo:

- Full desktop via `mstsc`
- RemoteApp launch via `/rdweb`

Key challenge solved:

- School DNS → hosts-file mapping + self-signed certificate